# Budget Template · Expert version

A budget template lets you plan spending by category and month, record actuals and see variances immediately, whether you are budgeting for a project, a team or your household.

## How to use this template

1. List income and cost categories that matter to you.
2. Enter planned amounts for the month (and the year on the second tab).
3. Record actual figures as they come in.
4. Check variances: totals and percentages calculate automatically.
5. Adjust next month's plan based on what you learn.

## Tips

- Update actuals weekly so surprises are small.
- Keep a contingency line.
- Use Google Sheets to share the budget with your team.
- For projects, track cost variance and EVM.

## Dashboard (sample data)

| Field | Value | Count |
|---|---|---|
| Category | Income | 1 |
| Category | Marketing | 1 |
| Category | Net (income − costs) | 1 |
| Category | Other | 1 |
| Category | Salaries / labour | 1 |
| Category | Software and tools | 1 |
| Category | Total costs | 1 |
| Category | Travel | 1 |

## Monthly budget · Positive variance = under budget for costs, above plan for income

| Category | Planned ($) | Actual ($) | Variance ($) | Variance (%) | Notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Income | 6,000 | 6,200 | 200 | 3% | |
| Salaries / labour | 3,000 | 3,100 | -100 | -3% | |
| Software and tools | 400 | 380 | 20 | 5% | |
| Marketing | 600 | 720 | -120 | -20% | Extra ad spend |
| Travel | 300 | 150 | 150 | 50% | |
| Other | 200 | 210 | -10 | -5% | |
| Total costs | 4,500 | 4,560 | -60 | -1% | |
| Net (income − costs) | 1,500 | 1,640 | 140 | | |
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## Annual by month · Twelve-month view

| Category | Jan | Feb | Mar | Apr | May | Jun | Jul | Aug | Sep | Oct | Nov | Dec | Total |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Income | 6,000 | 6,000 | 6,200 | 6,200 | 6,400 | 6,400 | 6,400 | 6,400 | 6,600 | 6,600 | 6,800 | 6,800 | 76,800 |
| Costs | 4,500 | 4,500 | 4,600 | 4,600 | 4,700 | 4,700 | 4,700 | 4,800 | 4,800 | 4,900 | 4,900 | 5,000 | 56,700 |
| Net | 1,500 | 1,500 | 1,600 | 1,600 | 1,700 | 1,700 | 1,700 | 1,600 | 1,800 | 1,700 | 1,900 | 1,800 | 20,100 |
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